

Ramoudane Orou S, PhD

Sustainability, Social & Climate Risk Specialist | Development Finance | Agrifood Systems
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SUMMARY

Sustainability and Social Risk Specialist with 8+ years of experience in Environmental & Social (E&S) risk management, safeguards, and sustainability across development finance and international organizations. Experienced in supporting investment due diligence, risk assessment, stakeholder engagement, and mitigation design, including in fragile and conflict-affected contexts. Strong understanding of international E&S frameworks, with portfolio exposure across infrastructure, agribusiness, and financial sectors. Proven ability to deliver high-quality analytical outputs, strengthen institutional capacity, and apply data-driven approaches to support risk-informed decision-making.

SUSTAINABILITY & TECHNICAL EXPERTISE

- Social Sustainability and Climate Risk (GARP SCR, Frankfurt School Certification)
- E&S Risk & Impact Assessment (IFC Performance Standards, World Bank ESF)
- Sustainability Reporting & Standards (GRI contributor – Agriculture Standard)
- Data-driven sustainability analytics (R, Python, GIS)

EXPERIENCE

INTERNATIONAL FINANCE CORPORATION (IFC)

Berlin, Germany

Private Sector Arm of the World Bank Group (WBG)

Contextual Risks Specialist

2024 - Present

- Conducted a methodological redesign and update of IFC's global Contextual Risk Index - a quantitative screening tool integrating socio-political, and environmental, indicators to inform investment decisions across 200+ countries.
- Assessed gender-based violence and harassment (GBVH) risks in investment due diligence across high-risk infrastructure and agribusiness projects, developing tailored mitigation frameworks and advising project teams on stakeholder engagement strategies, survivor-centred approaches, and ESMP requirements to address GBV risk exposure.
- Conducted a multi-track analytical work in preparation for the upcoming revision of IFC Performance Standard 7, comprising: a comparative analysis of PS7 and ILO Convention 169; a global review of legal instruments on Indigenous Peoples' rights across jurisdictions; and a synthesis of Indigenous Peoples' organizations' perspectives on rights frameworks - providing IFC with a comprehensive evidence base for standards development.
- Produced conflict sensitivity analyses and E&S risk management frameworks for investment projects across the solar, agribusiness, and manufacturing sectors, incorporating geospatial heatmaps built on ACLED and UNHCR data to identify FCV risk concentrations, investment exposure, and mitigation opportunities.
- Developed risk analyses assessing how local E&S dynamics intersect with proposed investments, providing analytical inputs to project teams and guiding senior management decisions on project viability, stakeholder engagement, and delivery in high-risk, low-capacity environments.
- Conducted portfolio-wide reviews of IFC investments across multiple FCV contexts (Nigeria, DRC, Chad, Cameroon, Mozambique, Ethiopia), tracking performance and advising on adaptive implementation strategies.
- Delivered real-time analytical briefs and situational risk updates to IFC country management and WBG operations during active crises, including the 2025 M23 resurgence in DRC and the September 2025 JNIM blockade in Mali.
- Contributed E&S risk analysis and investment recommendations to major WBG strategic documents including Risk and Resilience Assessments (RRAs), Country Partnership Frameworks (CPFs), Country Climate Development Reports (CCDRs), and Country Private Sector Diagnostics (CPSDs).
- Delivered private sector fragility and climate risk analyses for multiple CCDRs and CPFs, covering investment opportunities in climate mitigation and adaptation, climate-fragility linkages, and recommendations to manage project risks and strengthen resilience.
- Conducted field consultations for the Cameroon RRA, engaging government institutions, NGOs, private sector actors, academic representatives, and youth groups.
- Delivered advisory and capacity-building support to financial institutions (e.g., Equity Bank Kenya, Orange, SAMA Money), including the development of E&S risk assessment tools and training materials to embed ESG risk integration into investment operations.

UNITED NATIONS UNIVERSITY

Dresden, Germany

Institute for Integrated Management of Material Fluxes and of Resources (UNU-FLORES)

Researcher – Sustainability & Agri-food Systems

2021 - 2025

- Produced a global systematic review of social sustainability indicators in agrifood systems (published in Sustainable Production and Consumption, 2023), establishing rigorous methodological foundations for social safeguard design, E&S impact monitoring, and ESG-aligned investment screening.
- Published policy brief on women's financial access barriers in agroforestry value chains, providing evidence-based recommendations applicable to gender-inclusive investment design and E&S mitigation in agricultural finance.
- Developed proxy-based indicator frameworks to quantify non-observable environmental and social dimensions, directly applicable to social mitigation design, beneficiary analysis, and E&S impact assessment in data-scarce development contexts (SSA, Sahel).
- Applied advanced analytics (machine learning, NLP) to evaluate E&S indicators including labour conditions, water access, and gender inclusion, informing sustainability assessment frameworks used by development partners and multilateral institutions.
- Led multi-country research on the social dimension agrifood systems, including published policy brief on women's financial access and agroforestry (UNU-FLORES, 2025), directly relevant to quality assurance across outputs.
- Collaborated with FAO as World Food Forum Young Scientist (2023–2025), providing scientific evidence on agrifood systems sustainability to guide programme and investment design.

INTERNATIONAL FUND FOR AGRICULTURAL DEVELOPMENT (IFAD)

Home-based

Research Analyst

2021 - 2021

- Contributed to sub-regional impact evaluation of IFAD investment programmes across six fragile countries in the G5 Sahel and Northern Nigeria, assessing E&S sustainability, programme effectiveness, and safeguard alignment in climate-vulnerable, conflict-affected contexts

UNITED NATIONS POPULATION FUND (UNFPA)

Ouagadougou, Burkina Faso

UN Agency

Data Fellow - International Specialist

2019 - 2021

- Led large-scale data and analytical initiatives across 50+ countries, supporting policy and program design on social inclusion, governance, and development outcomes
- Managed multi-stakeholder processes and coordinated with government institutions, strengthening data-driven decision-making

AFRICAN UNION COMMISSION (AUC)

Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

Continental Organisation

Researcher

2018 - 2019

- Led a team of 14 researchers in producing the 2019 State of African Youth Report (SoAYR), coordinating all aspects of report development including work planning, task allocation, quality control, stakeholder consultation, and delivery of final outputs to AU Chairperson's Office
- Managed data collection, harmonization, and analysis across 55 African countries, consolidating inputs from national statistical offices, international databases, and AU systems into a unified monitoring framework aligned with the African Union Demographic Dividend pillars

EDUCATION

TECHNISCHE UNIVERSITÄT DRESDEN — TU DRESDEN

Dresden, Germany

Ph.D. in Integrated Management of Environmental Resources

2021 - 2025

- Thesis: The Social Dimension of Sustainability in Agri-food Systems (*Summa cum laude*)

YALE UNIVERSITY

USA, (Online)

Financing and Deploying Clean Energy (FDCE)

2025 - 2026

TECHNISCHE UNIVERSITÄT DRESDEN — TU DRESDEN

Dresden, Germany

Postgraduate Diploma in Environmental Management

2018 - 2018

UNIVERSITY OF PARAKOU

Parakou, Benin

MSc & BSc in Rural Economics and Sociology

2011 - 2017

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

World Food Forum (FAO) – Young Scientist | May 2023 – Apr 2025: Provided scientific evidence and technical expertise to the FAO, to guide initiatives on agri-food systems transformation

Global Reporting Initiative (GRI) – Subject Matter Expert : Peer-reviewed French translation of the GRI 13 Sector Standard on Agriculture, Aquaculture, and Fishing

Languages: French (native), English (fluent, TOEFL 107), German (intermediate - B1), Arabic (basic)

IT & Programming: R (Advanced), Python (Intermediary), SQL (Intermediary), ArcGIS (Intermediary)

CERTIFICATIONS

- GARP Sustainability & Climate Risk (SCR) | Certified Expert in Sustainable Finance (Frankfurt School of Finance & Management)
- Manage Impact Evaluations (World Bank) | Data Scientist with R (DataCamp)

PUBLICATIONS *(selected)*

- Orou Sannou R., Schneider C., Walz M., Guenther E., (2025), Organisational Innovations and Access to Sustainable Finance in Agriculture: The Case of Women Shea Farmers in Ghana, International Journal of Agricultural Sustainability, <https://doi.org/10.1080/14735903.2025.2469284>
- Orou Sannou R., Raja A., Hammami H., Ranjan R., Serano C. A. (2025), Empowering Women through Agroforestry: Breaking Financial Barriers for Community Resilience. UNU-FLORES, <https://unu.edu/sites/default/files/2025-08/KARE%20PB3%20Agroforestry%20Comm.pdf>
- Orou Sannou, R., Kirschke, S., Günther, E., (2023). Integrating the social perspective into the sustainability assessment of agri-food systems: A review of indicators. Sustainable Production and Consumption, <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.spc.2023.05.014>
- Orou Sannou R., Schneider C., (2026), Security Shaping Sustainability: The difference between securitised and community-based conservation in Benin. Sustainable Development, <https://doi.org/10.1002/sd.70731>
- Orou Sannou R. (2025), Shifting Climate Diplomacy: Positive Narratives for Accelerated Action. UNU Institute on Comparative Regional Integration Studies, <https://cris.unu.edu/shifting-climate-diplomacy-positive-narratives-accelerated-action>